

Lao  
ພາສາລາວ  
[p<sup>h</sup>aː˥saː˥laːw˥]

[github.com/cb-g/bhasa](https://github.com/cb-g/bhasa)

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# 1 Phonology

## 1.1 Vowels

|     |                                                                                     |
|-----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| i   | short close front unrounded vowel                                                   |
| i:  | long close front unrounded vowel                                                    |
| ɯ   | short close back unrounded vowel                                                    |
| ɯ:  | long close back unrounded vowel                                                     |
| u   | short close back rounded vowel                                                      |
| u:  | long close back rounded vowel                                                       |
| e   | short close-mid front unrounded vowel                                               |
| e:  | long close-mid front unrounded vowel                                                |
| ɤ   | short close-mid back unrounded vowel                                                |
| ɤ:  | long close-mid back unrounded vowel                                                 |
| o   | short close-mid back rounded vowel                                                  |
| o:  | long close-mid back rounded vowel                                                   |
| ɛ   | short open-mid front unrounded vowel                                                |
| ɛ:  | long open-mid front unrounded vowel                                                 |
| a   | short open central unrounded vowel                                                  |
| a:  | long open central unrounded vowel                                                   |
| ɔ   | short open-mid back rounded vowel                                                   |
| ɔ:  | long open-mid back rounded vowel                                                    |
| iaʔ | short centering diphthong: close front unrounded to open central, with glottal stop |
| ia  | long centering diphthong: close front unrounded to open central                     |
| uaʔ | short centering diphthong: close back unrounded to open central, with glottal stop  |
| ua  | long centering diphthong: close back unrounded to open central                      |
| uaʔ | short centering diphthong: close back rounded to open central, with glottal stop    |
| ua  | long centering diphthong: close back rounded to open central                        |

## 1.2 Tones

|          |                                                               |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| ˩ or ˨   | rising tone; endonym: sia:ŋʔkʰa:˩ or ʃia:ŋkʰã:                |
| ˥ or ˦   | high tone; endonym: sia:ŋʔsu:ŋ˥ or ʃia:ŋsú:ŋ                  |
| ˨˩ or ˨˥ | falling tone; endonym: sia:ŋʔtok˨˩ or ʃia:ŋtôk˨˥              |
| ˥˩ or ˦˥ | mid tone; endonym: sia:ŋʔkla:ŋ˥˩ or ʃia:ŋklā:ŋ                |
| ˨˥ or ˨˦ | low tone; endonym: sia:ŋʔtam˨˥ or ʃia:ŋtām                    |
| ˨˩˥      | mid-falling tone; endonym: sia:ŋʔkla:ŋ˨˩˥ or ʃia:ŋklā:ŋtôk˨˩˥ |

## 1.3 Consonants

|        |                                                                  |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| m      | voiced bilabial nasal                                            |
| b      | voiced bilabial plosive                                          |
| p      | voiceless bilabial plosive                                       |
| pʰ     | aspirated voiceless bilabial plosive                             |
| f      | voiceless labiodental fricative                                  |
| ʋ or w | voiced labiodental approximant or voiced labio-velar approximant |
| n      | voiced alveolar nasal                                            |
| d      | voiced alveolar plosive                                          |
| t      | voiceless alveolar plosive                                       |
| tʰ     | aspirated voiceless alveolar plosive                             |
| tʰw    | labialized aspirated voiceless alveolar plosive                  |
| s      | voiceless alveolar fricative                                     |
| sʷ     | labialized voiceless alveolar fricative                          |
| l      | voiced alveolar lateral approximant                              |
| lʷ     | labialized voiced alveolar lateral approximant                   |
| j      | voiced palatal nasal                                             |

|                 |                                                             |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| tʃ              | voiceless alveolo-palatal affricate                         |
| tʃ <sup>w</sup> | labialized voiceless alveolo-palatal affricate              |
| j               | voiced palatal approximant                                  |
| ŋ               | voiced velar nasal                                          |
| ŋ <sup>w</sup>  | labialized voiced velar nasal                               |
| k               | voiceless velar plosive                                     |
| k <sup>w</sup>  | labialized voiceless velar plosive                          |
| k <sup>h</sup>  | aspirated voiceless velar plosive                           |
| k <sup>hw</sup> | labialized aspirated voiceless velar plosive                |
| ʔ               | glottal stop                                                |
| ʔ <sup>w</sup>  | labialized glottal stop                                     |
| h               | voiceless glottal fricative                                 |
| ˀ               | no audible release (in syllable-final position: pˀ, tˀ, kˀ) |

## 2 Glosses

- (1) k<sup>h</sup>o:ŋ pen- ʔit<sup>˧</sup>ʔsa<sup>˧</sup>la<sup>˧</sup>ʔ  
1SG be.PRES.1SG free

ຂ້ອຍເປັນອິດສະລະ  
I am free.

- (2) tɕaw pen- mu: k<sup>h</sup>o:ŋ k<sup>h</sup>o:ŋ  
2SG be.PRES.2SG friend GEN 1SG

ເຈົ້າເປັນໝູ່ຂອງຂ້ອຍ  
You are my friend.

- (3) p<sup>h</sup>uak<sup>˧</sup>haw- ja:k<sup>˧</sup> mua- ba:n  
1PL want return home

ພວກເຮົາຢາກເມືອບ້ານ  
We want to go home.